



THE INSTITUTE OF
MASTERS
of WINE

IMW Tasting Lexicons

Tasting Vocabulary

Colour

Clarity, brilliant, bright, deep, dark, translucent, flushed, viscosity, limpid, mid-depth, opaque, light, dull, cloudy, pale.

Fruit

Forward, ripe, opulent, tropical, rich, generous, honeyed, supple, primary, secondary, exotic, concentrated, high-toned, grassy, vinous, leafy, sinewy, thin, lean, stemmy, appley, citrus, intensity, floral, clean, steely.

Acidity

Low, moderate, high, fresh, crisp, pronounced, marked, searing, racy, malic, tartaric, tart, refreshing, sour, bitter, astringent, flabby, soft.

Tannin

Soft, light, moderate, high, ripe, firm, rounded, silky, velvety, fine, grippy, broad, dry, dusty, aggressive, astringent, hard, coarse, harsh, green, oaky, stalky.

Alcohol

Low 7-10, moderate, high 13+, generous, burning, hot, spicity, watery.

Texture

Smooth, silky, opulent, velvety, rich, round, succulent, supple, persistent, viscous, voluptuous, soft, fat, concentrated, sinewy, thin, hard, steely, lean, dilute, clean, dry, sweet, flat, full bodied, flabby, mineral.

Structure

Light, delicate, supple, restrained, generous, firm, forward, broad, depth, elegant, fine, taut, concentrated, pure, thin, lean, grip, rigid, hard, unbalanced, steely, low intensity, muscular, neutral, subdued, weighty, fat, over-extracted, 1, dimensional, fractured, angular, backward, limp.

Quality

Integrated, balanced, harmonious, elegant, finesse, refined, length, prolonged, aftertaste, voluptuous, silky, racy, unbalanced, clumsy, dull, flat, austere, dilute, short, premium, mid-market, mid-range, bulk.

Maturity

Youthful, young, immature, fresh, vibrant, lively, developed, evolved, peaking, closed, mature, fading, drying out, dumb, tired, past it, aged, potential.

Oak

Toasted, buttery, integrated, cedar, coconut, vanillin, mocha, sweet.

Nose

Spicy, closed, open, oxidized, reductive, earthy, gamey, overt, sappy, grapey, tropical, pungent, aromatic, fragrant, mineral, herbaceous, restrained.

Synonyms and Other Useful Words

Positives

Striking, lively, vivid, prominent, defined, distinctive, appealing, attractive, rich, silky, racy, positive, intense, concentrated, persistent, pronounced, prolonged, integrated, harmonious, balanced, deep.

Negatives

Lack of, hollow, devoid of, subdued, lacks, restrained, flabby, undefined, dull, neutral, low key, obtrusive, shallow.

Suggests

Indicates, indicative of, points to, suggests, illustrates, demonstrates, expresses, establishes, shows, signifies, emphasizes, impression, potentially, consistent with, composition, typicality, emphasis on, incisive use of, evidence of, expansive.

Proves

Confirms, supports, shows, highlights, underlines, denotes, reveals, influenced by, defines, signifies.

Miscellaneous

Nuance, notes, block-busting, over-tones, characteristics, envelopes, weight, structure, texture, definition, provenance, integral.